KINGDOM COME

Details **Originally published** Kingdom Come #1-4 (1996) **Publisher** DC **Writer** Mark Waid
Artist Alex Ross **Collected in** Kingdom Come (£8.99) **Available digitally** Comixology

Kingdom Come is a symbolic struggle between idealism and darkness, rendered in beautiful photorealism. In this Elseworlds story, Superman, Wonder Woman and the rest of the old guard are pitted against a new, more violent breed of superheroes; meanwhile, Captain Marvel has been brainwashed into evil by Lex Luthor.

It's a clear break with the popular trend of grim 'n' gritty comics, emphasised by the callback to *The Dark Knight Returns* with a reclusive, grey-haired Batman and corporate giant Luthor's role in turning a symbol of cheerful bravery into a killer. Even today, look at the body count, dismemberment and cut-off faces of the New 52; Superman killing Zod in *Man Of Steel* or the stoney-faced solemnity of Christopher Nolan's film trilogy.

Mark Waid and Alex Ross's story of the triumph of optimism over grimness is no less significant than it was in 1996. We may want blood, but we need hope.







"A SYMBOLIC STRUGGLE BETWEEN IDEALISM AND DARKNESS"